

AI email outreach app

CSV in → Claude drafts → you approve → SMTP send → reply tracking → 14-day follow-up. Built on n8n + FastAPI + PostgreSQL + Next.js. You own the repo.

Start here
M1 · \$950 · 7–9 days

Full spec
4 milestones · \$3,450

Demo
ainoafv.github.io/ai-outreach-hitl-demo

What your job post requires — and where it lands

Requirement	Implementation	Phase
CSV / data import	POST /import/csv with column mapping; contacts stored in PostgreSQL	M1
AI-personalised emails	Claude Sonnet → JSON schema {subject, body, rationale}; prompt per campaign	M1
Review before send	Next.js dashboard: edit inline, approve/reject; demo shows this flow	M1
Send approved only	FastAPI sets status approved; n8n webhook fires SMTP/Gmail — rejects if not approved	M1
Reply monitoring	IMAP poll or inbound webhook; match by Message-ID; status → replied	M2
14-day follow-up	n8n cron: sent_at + 14d AND status != replied → new draft → second approval	M2
Multi-campaign dashboard	Campaign table + status filters (draft/sent/replied/follow-up pending)	M3
Enrichment	CSV columns + optional GET /enrich?url= (public page text, no LinkedIn scrape)	M4
Source + deploy	Git repo, Docker Compose, env docs, Loom walkthrough	M4

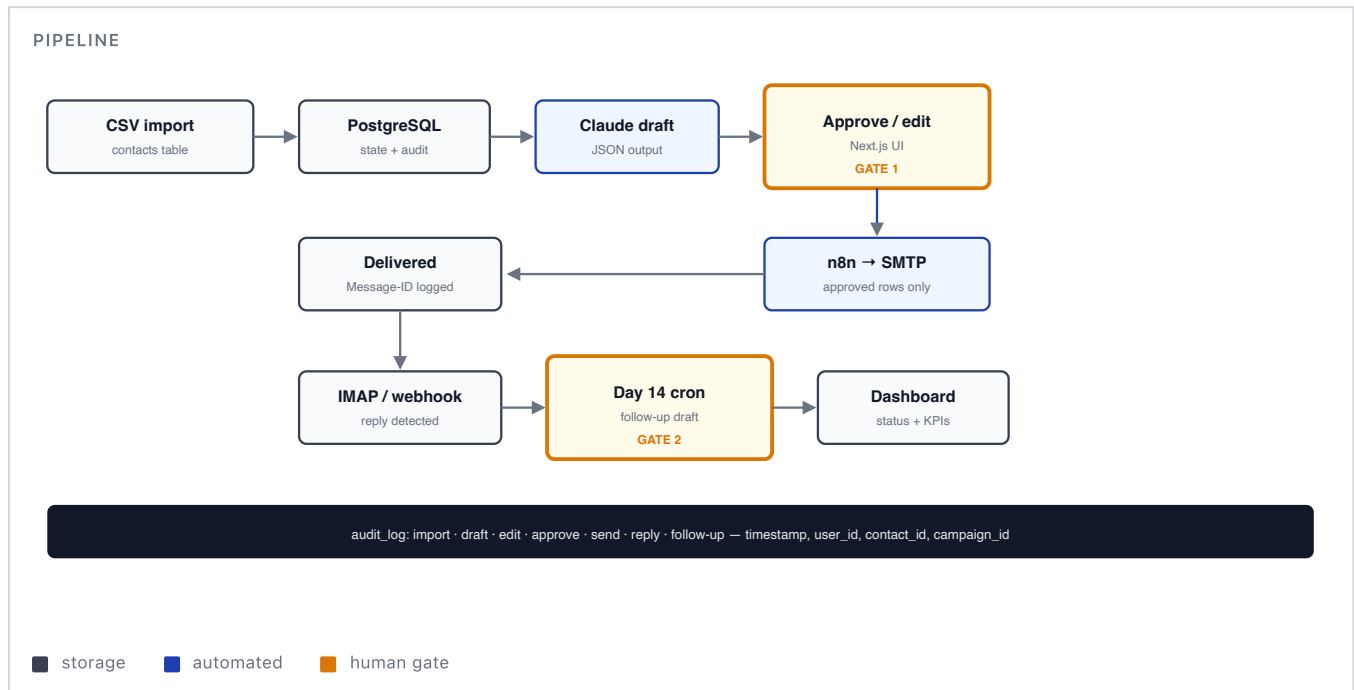
On the \$400 budget: full spec is ~90 h of work (UI, DB, n8n, LLM layer, inbound parsing, scheduler, multi-campaign admin, handoff). \$400 buys a Zapier template, not something your team can run at 500+ contacts. M1 (\$950) is the real entry point — working app, not a mockup.

Prior work that's relevant

- Production outbound agent (US B2B): approval gate before any SMTP call, append-only audit log
- CRM classifier: OpenAI → structured JSON with reason codes tied to business rules
- EU hospital AI pipeline: eval gate — nothing reaches users without passing checks

End-to-end flow

Two hard stops where a human must click approve. Everything else is automated.



Stack — why these choices

Layer	Pick	Reason
Automation	n8n	You asked for it; cron + webhooks without redeploying Python
LLM	Claude Sonnet	Better at long personalisation; schema-enforced JSON output
API	FastAPI	State machine, webhook endpoints, enrichment hooks
DB	PostgreSQL	Contacts, campaigns, email history, audit — one source of truth
UI	Next.js	Approval screen your staff actually uses; DE labels in M3 if needed
Email	SMTP / Gmail API	Your credentials, your domain reputation
Deploy	Docker	Your VPS or AWS — no dependency on my hosting

CH / EU constraints

- No send without explicit approval — enforced in API, not just UI
- No LinkedIn scraping — account ban + nDSG/GDPR issues; use CSV + public URLs only
- Audit log exportable per campaign (CSV/JSON)
- Data stays on infra you control

State machine (contact)

```
imported → draft → approved → sent → replied
                                     ↳ sent → follow_up_draft →
approved → sent
draft → rejected (terminal)
```

Phased delivery

Pay per milestone. Stop after any phase. Code is yours after each payment.

Phase	Price	Days	Deliverables
M1 — core loop ★	\$950	7–9	CSV import · 1 campaign · Claude drafts · approval UI · SMTP (approved-only) · PostgreSQL · staging deploy · docs
M2 — inbox + follow-up	\$900	6–8	IMAP/webhook reply detection · 14-day cron · follow-up draft + Gate 2 · scheduler in n8n
M3 — multi-campaign	\$850	5–7	Campaign manager · prompt per campaign · status dashboard · n8n workflow export
M4 — enrichment + handoff	\$750	4–6	URL enrichment plugin · repo transfer · Docker Compose · runbook · Loom
Total		~4 wk	\$3,450 — covers full job spec

Start with M1. It's usable on day 7–9 with real contacts. M2–M4 only after you sign off the previous phase.

Alternative: \$42/hr capped at \$3,800, same milestone structure.

M1 sign-off — six checks

#	Check	Pass condition
1	Import	50+ contacts from CSV, columns mapped correctly
2	Draft	Claude returns valid JSON subject + body for a real row
3	Gate	Calling send on draft status returns 403
4	Send	Approved email arrives in test inbox via your SMTP
5	Audit	Every transition written to <code>audit_log</code>
6	Handoff	Repo + <code>.env.example</code> + 5-min Loom

M1 schedule

Days	Work
1–2	Schema, CSV import, campaign model, Claude prompt v1, audit table
3–5	Approval UI, inline edit, SMTP via n8n, staging deploy
6–7	3 contacts end-to-end on staging, bugfix, docs

What I need from you

- Sample CSV (anonymised is fine) — I'll confirm column mapping day 1
- 2–3 emails that worked well — used as few-shot examples in the prompt
- Staging SMTP or Gmail OAuth + Claude/OpenAI API key
- Disclosure rules: what must appear in every email, what's forbidden
- UI language: English for v1, or German from the start?

How we work

- Async — Loom for walkthroughs, written updates; no standing calls
- GitHub repo per milestone; you get admin access at handoff
- Upwork chat for everything (audit trail)

To proceed

1. Open the demo — click through approve → send → follow-up
2. If the flow works for you, confirm M1 (\$950)
3. Fixed-price contract on Upwork for milestone 1
4. Send CSV + credentials → I start within 24h

M1 · \$950

Full spec: \$3,450 across M1–M4

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